

Wild Portals

Kithain society fears Wild Portals, for they often draw unwanted attention to the hidden world. Once upon a time, fae used them to attract mortals into their dominions without having to make an effort, but in modern nights missing people lead to headlines and public investigations. In turn, such reports attract Dauntain, who know what to look for when searching for targets.

Only those with faerie sight (Kenning) can detect Wild Portals. Sometimes the portals appear as swirling vortexes, hidden forest trails, or mirrors. There's no telling where a Wild Portal leads because of their unstable nature. Every time someone enters, the gateways begin to realign (a process taking a few minutes) to shift connection to a new trod.

It's possible to close Wild Portals by Unleashing either Oneiromancy or Wayfare to command the Dreaming to close. This doesn't always last, however (though incorporating the Time Realm helps). A more extreme way to close Wild Portals involves working to create Banality in their vicinity. In the end, the faerie soul suffers as much as the portal, often leading to gains of Banality before completing the task.

Creating Trods

Chronicles using the Dreaming include trod traveling, and this section provides Storytellers with guidelines to craft dream roads.

Step One: Nature

Determine what experiences the journey in the Dreaming is going to present players with. Is the aim to create a tale where the wayfaring tests their motley's bond, locating lost knowledge and Treasures, or where they conquer a trod belonging to the dark fae?

Step Two: Determine Gateway and Destination

If using established gateways, consider the nature of the accessible trod to define what the door requires to open. Also consider where it's located; a trod in a cemetery is going to have very different opening conditions than a trod at the bottom of a pristine lagoon. Gateways in locations full of Glamour created through positive experiences rarely lead to horrifying nightmare trods. This doesn't mean that the trod can't transition into one later on, of course; pleasant dreams can turn to nightmares in seconds. Consider also where the trod ends and how this influences the later part of the journey.

Step Three: Appearance, Control, and Challenges

Trods who've fallen victim to ancient curses may have twisted trees and bushes glowing along their darkened paths. Roads based on beautiful ancient tales involving light may appear as shimmering dust in the sun or moonlight. Trods come in numerous variations, from small forest trails to wide landscapes.

Seasons and holidays often affect trods in the Near Dreaming and leave marks on their appearances.

The trod controller influences the appearance quite heavily. A path belonging to boggans may appear as gently-laid cobblestones with a heavy smell of tobacco, but it might also be that the stones are actually clotted blood and have a strong scent of flesh burning over the stove. Imagine what sort of creatures and individuals reside along the way and how they influence the pathway.

Finally, determine what sort of obstacles the travelers have to overcome while on the road between locations. These obstacles ranges from knightly duels on sidhe-controlled paths of honor and glory, to having to perform an autopsy (or vivisection) to find the solution to a dreadful enigma on a nightmare trod. In fact, the very nature of the trod may present a challenge of its own. Consider if the motley needs wings, chimerical vehicles, ships, or similar factors to use the trod.

The Three Roads

Trods fall into one of three categories: Silver Path, Paths of Balor, and Twilight.

The Silver Path

Silver Path trods have a shining thread running throughout, from entrance to end. This is the visible effect of an ancient ban that the Tuatha de Danaan cast during the War of Trees in order to protect their troops and allies from the Elder Dark's minions. Dark-kin, Thallain, and any chimeras or beasts touched by darkness (see Chapter Nine for a thorough discussion of these beings) or Fomorian corruption cannot use these trods without suffering great pain. The only Dark-kin exempt from the effects are the moirae and keremet, who took a neutral stance in the conflict.

Changelings and Tuathan allies may set aside the ban and allow a creature touched by darkness to use the road for a brief while. This action costs 1 point of Glamour and lasts while traveling on a single trod. Once the dark fae (or chimera) leaves the main path, the protection wears off.

Silver Ban Effects — Applicable to Dark-kin and Thallain:

- ☉ Lose 1 Glamour per turn. Once out of Glamour, reduce health levels at the same rate. The purity of the Silver Path burns in the souls of nightmares.
- ☉ Spend an additional point of Glamour to initiate attacks against protected individuals, or suffer a -2 dice penalty on all combat actions.

Paths of Balor

The Paths of Balor are older than the Silver Path and are one-way roads the dark fae used during the Tessarakonta. They are divided into three categories, based on where they exit.

- ☉ **Black:** Black paths run across all planes and it's even possible to gain access to one directly from the Autumn world. They're mostly used to travel to the Shadowlands, home of the dead. Rumor has it that the keremet use them for guiding the souls of humans whose bodies were taken by sidhe.